# Financial Dashboard

Desert Bloom Florist

**100 pts**

Unit 3 — Excel Spreadsheets · Core Project Option A

/ 100 points · 40 tasks

**How to use this instruction sheet:** Download the starter file from the Project Grader, open it in Microsoft Excel 365, and keep this sheet beside you. Work through each task in order. Each task tells you what to do, why it matters, where to find it, and the correct formula syntax — but you must enter the formula yourself. The starter file contains clean data only — no instructions are embedded in the file itself.

## E1 — Manage Worksheets & Workbooks

18 points (8 tasks)

**2**

### Task 1 — Add a new worksheet to the workbook and rename it "Expense Log"

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Real financial workbooks use multiple sheets to organize different types of data. Adding and naming sheets keeps your work organized and professional.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Right-click any sheet tab at the bottom of Excel → Insert → Worksheet. Then double-click the new tab and type "Expense Log". Press Enter.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A new sheet tab labeled "Expense Log" appears at the bottom of the workbook.*

**2**

### Task 2 — Freeze row 3 and column A so headers stay visible while scrolling

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Financial dashboards have many columns. Freezing keeps the header row and category column visible as you scroll right and down.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click cell B4 (one below and one right of where you want to freeze). View tab → Freeze Panes group → Freeze Panes.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Dark lines appear below row 3 and to the right of column A. Scroll right — month headers stay visible.*

2

### Task 3 — Define a named range "MonthlyRevenue" for cells B4:M4

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Named ranges make formulas readable. =SUM(MonthlyRevenue) is clearer than =SUM(B4:M4) and easier to audit.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select B4:M4. Click the Name Box (top-left, shows cell address). Type MonthlyRevenue. Press Enter.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Click the Name Box dropdown — "MonthlyRevenue" appears in the list.*

2

### Task 4 — Add Quick Print to the Quick Access Toolbar

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

The Quick Access Toolbar gives one-click access to frequently used commands. Quick Print saves time when printing dashboards for meetings.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

File → Options → Quick Access Toolbar → Choose commands from: All Commands → find Quick Print → Add → OK.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A printer icon appears in the Quick Access Toolbar at the very top of the Excel window.*

2

### Task 5 — Set the print area to A3:N7 and set page orientation to Landscape

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Setting a print area tells Excel exactly what to print. Landscape fits wide financial tables on a single page.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select A3:N7. Page Layout → Print Area → Set Print Area. Then Page Layout → Orientation → Landscape.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Page Layout view shows the print boundary around A3:N7 on a wide Landscape page.*

2

### Task 6 — Apply the "Office" workbook theme

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Themes apply coordinated fonts and colors throughout the workbook, giving it a consistent professional appearance.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Page Layout tab → Themes group → Themes → click the Office theme (usually first in the gallery).

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The workbook fonts and color scheme update to the Office theme palette.*

2

### Task 7 — Set workbook properties: Title = "Desert Bloom Financial Dashboard 2026", Author = your name

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Document properties embed metadata identifying the file's purpose and creator — important for file management and sharing.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

File tab → Info → Properties panel on the RIGHT side → click Title field and type the title → click Author and type your name.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*File → Info shows the correct Title and Author in the Properties panel.*

4

### Task 8 — Save a copy of the workbook as PDF for the owner review

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

PDFs preserve formatting exactly and cannot be accidentally edited — the standard format for sharing financial reports with management.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

File tab → Save As → choose location → click Save as type dropdown → PDF (*.pdf) → Save.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A PDF file appears in your folder. Open it to confirm the dashboard formatting looks correct.*

## E2 — Manage Data Cells & Ranges

18 points (8 tasks)

2

### Task 9 — Use AutoFill to extend the month series January through December across row 3

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

AutoFill recognizes patterns and extends them automatically — much faster and more accurate than typing each month manually.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

The starter file has "January" in B3 and "February" in C3. Select both cells. Drag the fill handle (small square, bottom-right of selection) rightward through column M.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Cells B3 through M3 show January through December in order.*

2

### Task 10 — Insert two new rows above row 3 for the dashboard title and subtitle

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Title rows make the dashboard immediately identifiable when opened or printed.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click row number 3 to select the entire row. Hold Shift and click row 4. Right-click → Insert. Two blank rows appear above the data.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Two new blank rows appear above your month headers. All data shifts down.*

2

### Task 11 — Format all revenue cells (B4:M4) as Currency with 2 decimal places

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Currency formatting adds the $ symbol and decimal places, making financial figures immediately recognizable.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select B4:M4. Home tab → Number group → click the $ Currency button. Or press Ctrl+1 → Number → Currency → 2 decimal places.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Revenue cells show values like $42,000.00 with dollar signs and commas.*

2

### Task 12 — Merge cells A1:N1 and center the dashboard title

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

A merged, centered title spanning the dashboard width gives it a professional report appearance.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select A1:N1. Home tab → Alignment group → Merge & Center. Type the title.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A1:N1 appears as one wide cell with the title centered inside it.*

2

### Task 13 — Right-align all numeric columns; center all month header labels in row 3

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Numbers right-aligned so decimal points line up vertically. Headers centered over their data looks balanced.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select numeric data → Home → Right Align. Select B3:M3 → Home → Center.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Month names are centered in row 3. Revenue and expense numbers are right-aligned.*

2

### Task 14 — Use Format Painter to copy the revenue row formatting to the expenses row

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Format Painter copies all formatting instantly from one range and applies it to another.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click any revenue row cell. Home → Clipboard → Format Painter brush. Click and drag across the expenses row.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The expenses row has the same Currency formatting, font, and alignment as the revenue row.*

3

### Task 15 — Apply conditional formatting to highlight months where Net Profit is negative (red fill)

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Conditional formatting makes problem data jump out visually. Red fill on negative profit months immediately flags issues.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select Net Profit cells (row 6, cols B:M). Home → Conditional Formatting → Highlight Cells Rules → Less Than → type 0 → Red Fill.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Any profit cell with a negative value turns red. Positive months remain unformatted.*

3

### Task 16 — Name the expense range "MonthlyExpenses" using the Name Box

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Naming the expense range enables readable formulas like =SUM(MonthlyExpenses) throughout the dashboard.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select B5:M5. Click the Name Box. Type MonthlyExpenses. Press Enter.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The Name Box dropdown shows both "MonthlyRevenue" and "MonthlyExpenses".*

## E3 — Manage Tables & Table Data

14 points (6 tasks)

2

### Task 17 — Convert the product sales data range on the Products sheet to an Excel Table

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Excel Tables auto-expand, enable structured references, and make sorting and filtering much easier.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click any cell in the product data on the Products sheet. Insert tab → Tables → Table → confirm range → check "My table has headers" → OK.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The data has alternating colored rows and dropdown arrows in the header row. Table Design tab appears.*

2

### Task 18 — Apply a blue Medium table style

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Table styles make data easier to read with alternating colors and styled headers.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click inside the table. Table Design tab → Table Styles gallery → find a blue Medium style → click it.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The table uses a blue color scheme with styled header row.*

2

### Task 19 — Add a Total Row showing the sum of Units Sold and total Revenue

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

The Total Row automatically calculates column totals with a dropdown to choose SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, etc.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click inside the table. Table Design tab → Table Style Options → check Total Row.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A Total row appears. Click each numeric column dropdown and select SUM.*

2

### Task 20 — Filter the table to show only products with Revenue over $5,000

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Filtering lets you focus on top-performing products without deleting anything.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the Revenue column dropdown arrow → Number Filters → Greater Than → type 5000 → OK.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Only rows where Revenue exceeds $5,000 are visible. Row numbers skip — filtered rows are hidden, not deleted.*

2

### Task 21 — Sort the product table by Revenue from largest to smallest

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Sorting by revenue descending puts your best-performing products at the top.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the Revenue column dropdown arrow → Sort Largest to Smallest.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The table rows are reordered with the highest revenue product at the top.*

4

### Task 22 — Remove any duplicate product entries from the table

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Duplicate data distorts totals and reports. Remove Duplicates finds and deletes exact duplicate rows automatically.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click inside the table. Table Design tab → Tools group → Remove Duplicates → select columns to check → OK.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Excel shows "1 duplicate value found and removed." The red duplicate row is gone.*

## E4 — Formulas & Functions

32 points (12 tasks)

2

### Task 23 — Write =SUM(MonthlyRevenue) in the Total Revenue summary cell

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

SUM is the most fundamental Excel function. Using the named range makes the formula self-documenting.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the empty Total Revenue cell in the summary area. Type the formula and press Enter.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=SUM(MonthlyRevenue)
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The cell displays the sum of all 12 monthly revenue values ($551,800).*

2

### Task 24 — Write =AVERAGE(MonthlyRevenue) in the Average Monthly Revenue cell

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

AVERAGE calculates the mean monthly revenue — the typical figure used for planning and forecasting.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the empty Average Monthly Revenue cell.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=AVERAGE(MonthlyRevenue)
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The cell shows approximately $45,983.*

2

### Task 25 — Write =MAX(MonthlyRevenue) for Best Month and =MIN(MonthlyRevenue) for Worst Month

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

MAX and MIN identify peak and lowest performance months — critical for understanding seasonality.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click Best Month cell → type MAX formula. Click Worst Month cell → type MIN formula.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=MAX(MonthlyRevenue) and =MIN(MonthlyRevenue)
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Best Month shows $55,400. Worst Month shows $38,200.*

2

### Task 26 — Write =COUNT(B4:M4) to count months with recorded revenue

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

COUNT verifies data completeness by counting how many cells contain numbers.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the empty Months Recorded cell.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=COUNT(B4:M4)
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The cell shows 12 — all twelve months have revenue data.*

3

### Task 27 — Write an IF formula in the Profit Status row: if profit > 0 show "Profitable", else "Loss"

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

IF formulas convert numeric results into human-readable labels for non-financial stakeholders.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the first empty Profit Status cell (row 7, column B). Copy across through column M.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=IF(B6>0,"Profitable","Loss")
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Each month shows "Profitable" or "Loss" based on its Net Profit value.*

3

### Task 28 — Write COUNTIF to count how many months were profitable

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

COUNTIF counts cells meeting a condition. Knowing profitable months is a key business metric.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the empty Profitable Months cell in the summary area.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=COUNTIF(B6:M6,">0")
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The cell shows the count of months where Net Profit was greater than zero.*

3

### Task 29 — Write SUMIF to total revenue only for months where profit exceeded $2,000

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

SUMIF adds values meeting a condition — identifying which months generated both revenue AND strong profit.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the empty SUMIF result cell in the summary area.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=SUMIF(B6:M6,">2000",B4:M4)
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The cell shows total revenue from months where Net Profit exceeded $2,000.*

3

### Task 30 — Use CONCAT to combine the month name and year into a label (e.g. "January 2026")

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

CONCAT joins text strings. Month+year labels are useful for reports, charts, and pivot tables.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the first CONCAT cell. Copy across all 12 months.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=CONCAT(B3," 2026")
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Each cell shows the month name followed by " 2026" — e.g., "January 2026".*

2

### Task 31 — Use TODAY() to display the report generation date in the summary area

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

TODAY() updates automatically to the current date every time the workbook is opened.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the empty Report Date cell in the summary area.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=TODAY()
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The cell shows today's date. It will update automatically each day.*

2

### Task 32 — Use YEAR() and MONTH() to extract the year and month from the report date

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

YEAR() and MONTH() extract specific parts of a date — useful for grouping and labeling time-based reports.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click Report Year cell → type YEAR formula. Click Report Month cell → type MONTH formula.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=YEAR(TODAY()) and =MONTH(TODAY())
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Year cell shows 2026. Month cell shows the current month number (1-12).*

4

### Task 33 — Write VLOOKUP to pull the product category from the Reference sheet

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

VLOOKUP finds a value in a table and returns a corresponding value from another column — connecting data across sheets.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the first empty Category cell in the lookup section of the Dashboard sheet.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=VLOOKUP(A23,Reference!$A$3:$B$12,2,FALSE)
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Category names appear (e.g., "Floral" for Rose Bouquet). FALSE means exact match only.*

4

### Task 34 — Wrap the VLOOKUP in IFERROR to show "Unknown" if the product is not found

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

IFERROR catches #N/A errors and replaces them with a friendly message instead of an ugly error code.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Edit the VLOOKUP formula and wrap the entire thing with IFERROR.

**FORMULA SYNTAX**

```
=IFERROR(VLOOKUP(A23,Reference!$A$3:$B$12,2,FALSE),"Unknown")
```

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*"UnknownProduct" shows "Unknown" instead of #N/A.*

## E5 — Manage Charts

18 points (6 tasks)

3

### Task 35 — Create a Line chart showing monthly revenue trend across all 12 months

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Line charts are ideal for showing trends over time. A revenue trend chart shows growth, decline, or seasonality instantly.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select B3:M4 (month headers and revenue data). Insert tab → Charts → Insert Line or Area Chart → Line.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A line chart appears showing 12 data points connected by a line, one per month.*

2

### Task 36 — Move the revenue Line chart to its own chart sheet named "Revenue Trend"

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Chart sheets give charts full-page display without crowding the data worksheet.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the chart. Chart Design tab → Location → Move Chart → New sheet → type "Revenue Trend" → OK.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A new "Revenue Trend" sheet tab appears containing only the chart at full size.*

3

### Task 37 — Add a Column chart to the Products sheet showing product sales by category

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Column charts are best for comparing values across categories.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Select product name and revenue columns on the Products sheet. Insert → Column or Bar Chart → Clustered Column.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*A column chart appears with one bar per product, heights representing revenue.*

3

### Task 38 — Add chart title "Product Sales by Category" and data labels to the column chart

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Titles identify the chart. Data labels display exact values so readers don't have to estimate from the axis.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click chart. Chart Design → Add Chart Element → Chart Title → Above Chart. Type title. Then Add Chart Element → Data Labels → Outside End.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The chart has a title at the top. Each bar shows its exact revenue value.*

3

### Task 39 — Apply Chart Style 6 to the column chart

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Chart styles apply coordinated colors and formatting for a polished professional appearance.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Click the column chart. Chart Design tab → Chart Styles group → Style 6.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*The chart updates with the Style 6 color scheme.*

4

### Task 40 — Add descriptive alt text to both charts for accessibility compliance

**WHY THIS MATTERS**

Alt text describes charts to screen reader users. Required for ADA-compliant workplace documents.

**WHERE TO FIND IT**

Right-click each chart → Edit Alt Text → type a clear description of what each chart shows.

**HOW YOU'LL KNOW IT WORKED**

*Right-clicking each chart shows the Alt Text pane with your description filled in.*